

Developing Soft Skills and Personality



Professor T. Ravichandran

Department of Humanities and Social Sciences, IIT Kanpur

Week 1
Module 1
Lecture 1

Course Introduction

How to learn this course ?



LEARNING

????

What does **learning** mean to you?

Learning?

Does it mean . . .

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Cramming of text books?

Mindless reproduction of memorised ideas?

Getting something on paper?

Showing off somebody the certificates, degrees and medals accumulated?

Is it mere increase of knowledge?

Ability to memorise and reproduce?

Gather facts and store it for future use

Search for meaning?

Understand reality and know how to interpret it correctly?

Real learning actually means . . .

**Human interaction
with the environment that results in
a permanent change in behaviour.**

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—
This means:
All learning is not done by reading books
Most learning is done outside the classrooms
Much depends on our interaction with the environment (class room, friends, enemies, books, movies, nature, etc.)
In whatever way one learns, if it does not result in behaviour modification, it is not learnt at all!



*At its best,
it will provide you
with a conducive
environment for
learning*

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**What can this
course do to YOU?**



What can this
course do to
you?

- **It could change your life, revolutionise your thinking, alter your perspective, develop your career, enrich your personal relationships, enhance your happiness quotient . . .**
- **BUT .. IF ONLY ..**

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But . . .
Only if . . .



You can lead a horse to water,
but you can't make him drink.

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*Only if . . . you WANT to change, the
course can change you!*



You need to desire change

To desire change, you need to believe that you can change;

To change your belief, you need to have faith in the course

If you start believing that the course can help you make positive change in your behaviour and have faith in the instructor, then--

You will start modifying your thoughts; and do lots of unlearning and relearning

You will use good words, which guide your positive actions,

Soon you will develop healthy habits, which will get reinforced in your character, and determine your destiny!

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**Tips for gaining maximum
benefit out of this course**



Preparing to Learn: Normal and Fuzzy Modes

Normal: Download the videos as when it is posted in NPTEL Site.

Have them on your lap top, desk top, mobile, wherever possible.

Fuzzy: Download at least a day before the quiz or assignment !

Normal: Schedule an hour each day for learning the course. Choose a calm environment. As you watch the videos, listen carefully and keep a notebook for taking notes. Reflect on them before you sleep. Discuss with friends.

Fuzzy: Watch the videos wherever it is possible for you. On your bed, inside the bus, while in restroom, while eating . . . But make it a point to finish the lessons before the weekly quiz. Jot down some points!

Moving Ahead . . .

Whether you want the Certificate or not . . .

Sincerely attempt all quizzes, assignments and the final exam (this will help you assess your learning progress)

The learning has to be **experiential** if you really want to have the behavioural change in you. This means—

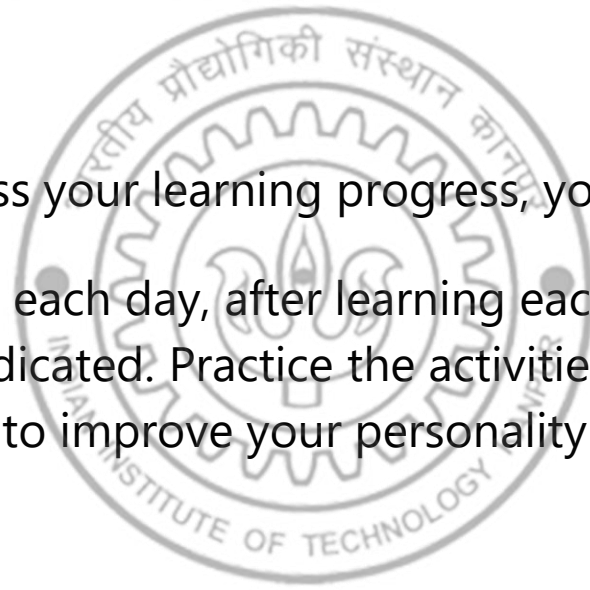
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You need to be honest with yourself. You may have group discussions on concept clarity. But while answering the quizzes, rely on your own insights gained from the course.



Assessment

As we assess your learning progress, you may assess your personal progress.

Ensure that each day, after learning each lesson, you will adapt to the new changes indicated. Practice the activities suggested for developing soft skills. Each week, seek to improve your personality!



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Approaches to teaching soft skills



Others: External factors; physical changes

My approach: Aims at intrinsic factors and overall development of personality

Changes that affect at all levels:

Physical

Mental

Emotional

Psychological

Cultural

Spiritual

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Developing Soft Skills and Personality (Personal and Professional Skills)

Enhancing Soft Skills and Personality (Interpersonal and Management Skills)

8 Weeks: 6 Modules (25 mins) in a Week (48 modules—20 hours)

Self-Assessment; Identifying Strength & Limitations; Habits, Will-Power and Drives; Developing Self-Esteem and Building Self-Confidence, Significance of Self-Discipline

Understanding Perceptions, Attitudes, and Personality Types

Mind-Set: Growth and Fixed; Values and Beliefs

Motivation and Achieving Excellence; Self-Actualisation Need

Goal Setting, Life and Career Planning; Constructive Thinking

Communicating Clearly: Understanding and Overcoming barriers

Active Listening; Persuasive Speaking and Presentation Skills

Conducting Meetings, Writing Minutes, Sending Memos and Notices

Netiquette: Effective E-mail Communication; Telephone Etiquette

Body Language in Group Discussion and Interview



May your journey of
self-discovery begin . . .



*The Romance of Self-Discovery
Is an Endless Process...
Enjoy Every Moment*



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Week 1
Module 2
Lecture 2

Soft Skills

Planning & Goal-Setting

If God
grants you
one wish
that would
make you
happy and
peaceful
forever,
what
should you
ask Him?



- Money
- Intelligence
- Knowledge
- Good looks
- Beautiful/handsome life partner

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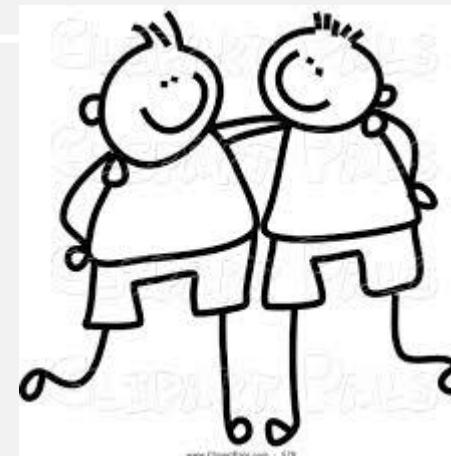
You should ask
Him for
Soft Skills!

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- It will bring you everything that you need to live a happy and peaceful life!
- Soft Skills are People Skills
- Remember: It's the people around you who are going to contribute to your success or failure.
- 80% of your happiness and peace depends on the life or business partner with whom you spend your maximum time with!
- It's important that you know how to interact with them to bring harmony and peace in your life!
- Before you learn how to make them give what you want, you need to know what you really want in this life?!

A Story to begin with . . .



**“Begin with the end
in mind.”**

- Stephen R. Covey



Now think deeply.

What would you like each of these speakers to say about you and your life?

What kind of husband, wife, father, or mother would you like their words to reflect? What kind of son or daughter or cousin? What kind of friend?

What kind of working associate?

What character would you like them to have seen in you?

What contributions, what achievements would you want them to remember ? Look carefully at the people around you.

What difference would you like to have made in their



Steve Jobs Commencement Address

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UF8uR6Z6KLc>

Remembering that I'll be dead soon is the most important tool I've ever encountered to help me make the big choices in life. Because almost everything — all external expectations, all pride, all fear of embarrassment or failure - these things just fall away in the face of death, leaving only what is truly important.

Remembering that you are going to die is the best way I know to avoid the trap of thinking you have something to lose. You are already naked. There is no reason not to follow your heart.

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No one wants to die. Even people who want to go to heaven don't want to die to get there. And yet death is the destination we all share. No one has ever escaped it. And that is as it should be, because **Death is very likely the single best invention of Life. It is Life's change agent.** It clears out the old to make way for the new. Right now the new is you, but someday not too long from now, you will gradually become the old and be cleared away. Sorry to be so dramatic, but it is quite true.

Being the richest man in the cemetery doesn't matter to me. Going to bed at night saying we've done something wonderful... that's what matters to me.

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*Your work is going to fill a large part of your life, and the only way to be truly satisfied is to do what you believe is great work. And **the only way to do great work is to love what you do.** If you haven't found it yet, keep looking. Don't settle.*

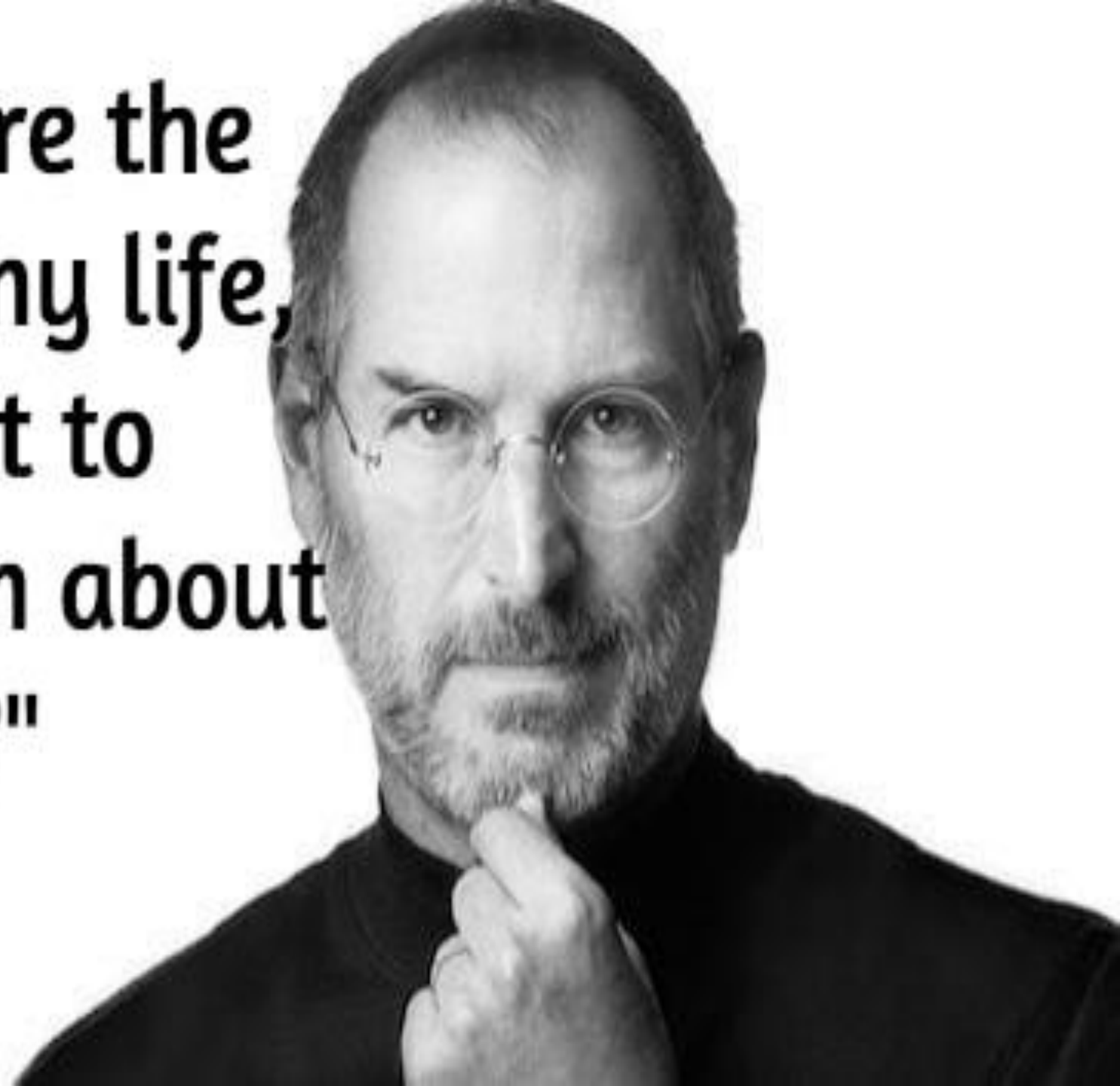


You have to trust in something — your gut, destiny, life, karma, whatever. This approach has never let me down...

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**"If today were the
last day of my life,
would I want to
do what I am about
to do today?"**



How do you conceptualise the End

One obvious meaning is DEATH

Which means we have to ascertain our purpose, meaning, and mission in life and live a fruitful life before death catches us unawares.

Other possible ways in which we can interpret END:

End of this video; the course; your career at your college; new career at another place; new job; end of a job; new position; promotion; higher post; change in areas/fields, etc.

End of the day; week; month; year; 5 years; 10 years; 15 years; 25 years; lifetime

Plans ahead and set your goals and objectives.

Do things that will have a meaning and make a difference in your life.

Answer these questions . . .

What have you planned to do at the end of this course?

What will you be doing at the end of your degree and graduation?

Where will you be after 5 years; 10 years; 15 years; 25 years?

What is your lifetime mission?

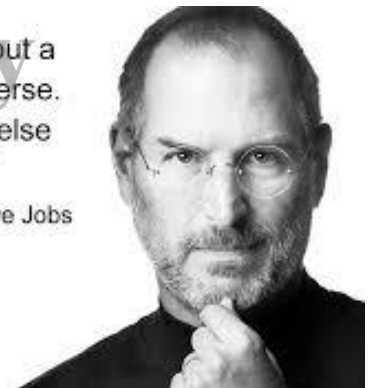
How would you like to visualize it by breaking into small and achievable parts?

What would you finally be as a self-actualized individual?

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"We're here to put a dent in the universe.
Otherwise why else
even be here?"

~ Steve Jobs



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Week 1
Module 3
Lecture 3

Human Perceptions

Understanding People

Highlights

Highlights of the Last Lecture



- Soft skills are people skills
- Your association and interaction with people contribute to success or failure in your life.
- 80% of your happiness quotient is determined by your life partner or boss—to whom you spend your maximum time with.
- So you need to work on your soft skills and develop your personality to achieve what you want in your life.
- BUT : You need to be sure of what you want in your life.
- In fact, you should have a clear sense of purpose and vision based on which you make your mission statement!
- To be clearly purpose oriented, you need to begin with the end in mind.
- Each day you need to begin a task with the result in mind.
- You should stop doing any task that will not add any value to your life and development of your personality.

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**Did you watch Steve Job's
Commencement Address?**



Perceptual Difference

Perceptual Differences . . .







← 50% AIR

← 50% WATER

TECHNICALLY

THE GLASS IS COMPLETELY FULL

When asked if my cup is half-full or half-empty my only response is that I am thankful I have a cup.

~ Sam Lefkowitz

One day, someone showed me a glass of water that was half full. And he said, Is it half full or half empty? So I drank the water. No more problem.

~ Alexander Jodorowsky

Remember your glass is half full not half empty, live life to the max and remember that no matter how bad your day is someone's day is worse.

An optimist will tell you the glass is half-full; the pessimist, half-empty; and the engineer will tell you the glass is twice the size it needs to be.

~ Oscar Wilde

It doesn't matter if the glass is half empty or half full. Be thankful that you have a glass and grateful that there's something in it.

Optical Illusions

This is definitely one of the best-known **optical illusions** of all times! What do you see at first glance - an old woman or a young miss? They are both there!



**Whole family mind teaser -
father with mother and daughter**



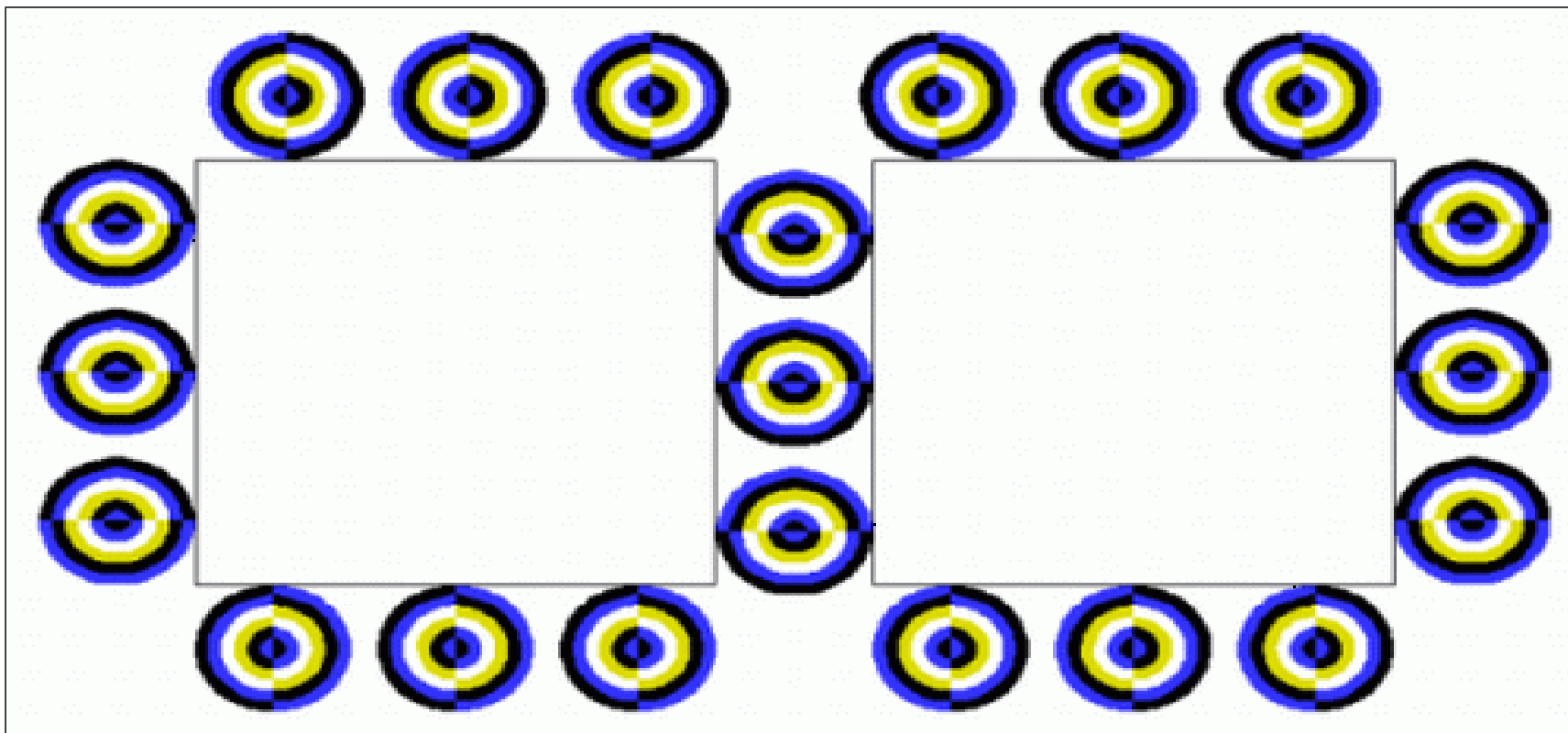
**An old couple -
see profiles of faces -
is remembering the times when they were young
and full of life - see the sitting characters**



Rabbit and Duck



Moving Circles



Looking at the things from other's perspective

e.g. Steven Covey's paradigm shift

(New York subway car)

Don't be guided by prejudice!!

Seek first to understand, then to be understood!

-Stephen R. Covey

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Week 1
Module 4
Lecture 4

Types of Soft Skills

Self-Management Skills

Highlights

Highlights of the Last Lecture



- Human perceptions determine proper understanding in relationships.
- Perceptions are bound to be different; often contradictory!
- Don't be guided by prejudice.
- Before showing your anger on somebody's annoying behaviour find out what makes the person to behave so.
- Seek first to understand and then to be understood (Steven Covey)!
- Do not be satisfied with doing the minimum required learning for this course.
- Learn eagerly from the extra materials suggested
- such as Steven Covey's *7 Habits of Highly Effective People* and Steve Jobs' Commencement Address.

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Have I taught you some soft skills so far?

Have you learnt any soft skills so far?

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If yes, what are they?

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Self-Management, Emotion Regulation & Time-Management Skills

- Implicitly I taught you in the 1 Module: Preparing and Planning
- In the 2nd Module: Self-awareness with regard to having a clear sense of purpose
- Thinking about the end-result before beginning a new task
- This helps in knowing your priorities
- Identifying high-value and low-value and no-value tasks
- Committing to do only high-value tasks
- Using will-power and perseverance to complete the tasks in time
- Understanding perceptual differences
- Empathising with others

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• Self-Awareness

Why are you lazy? What will make you work without expecting any reward? Who or what inspires you? What makes you angry? When do you remain calm and peaceful? What are you afraid of? When do you feel embarrassed? Why do you get frustrated? What are your driving forces? Why do you postpone things? Why do you do things before time? Why are you jealous of someone? When do you appreciate someone? Why do you get attracted to someone or something? Why do you get addicted to something? Why do you hate someone? Why do you love someone?

Self- Management Skills Set

• Self-Confidence

Are you confident all the time? When are you over-confident? When do you lack in confidence? Do you believe in you that you have strength and power within you to achieve anything?

• Mind-Set

Do you have a positive or negative mind-set? Is your mind always looks at problems or comes out with solutions to problems? Do you have a rigid, fixed mind set, or a flexible and growth mind-set? Is your mind looking for opportunity to learn and grow even in difficult situations? Or, it indulges in complaining and blaming others?

• Emotional Balance

How good is your emotional literacy? And the level of your emotional intelligence (EQ)? Are you able to control your emotions? Do you feel weak before some people? Do you feel intimidated when you meet people who are more powerful or stronger or richer? Can you manage your negative emotions such as anger, frustration and hurt? Can you think rationally and make objective decisions when you are consumed with your own emotion? Are you afraid of sharing your innermost feelings? Can you share your love for someone without getting nervous?

Self- Management Skills Set

• Handling Stress

Do you remain cool, calm and collected in any situations? Are you strained when you interact with people at personal and professional levels? Do you know how to come out of a stressful situation? Are you aware that the less stressful you are the more productive you will be?

• Coping with Failure

*Do you have the **resilience** to bounce back after a set-back? Do you have the **persistence and perseverance** to continue with your plan despite obstacles and oppositions? Do you have the **will-power and determination** to work with the same energy till your mission is accomplished?*

- **Patience, Tolerance & Trustworthiness**

Do you have the wisdom to remain calm when others rush? Can you patiently wait for the appropriate time to initiate action?

Do you have a high level of tolerance? Are you intolerant of people whose qualities annoy you?

Can people trust you? Are you responsible and committed? Do you speak the truth or occasionally tell lies? Do you have good standards of honesty and integrity? Do you act ethically?

**Self-
Management
Skills Set**

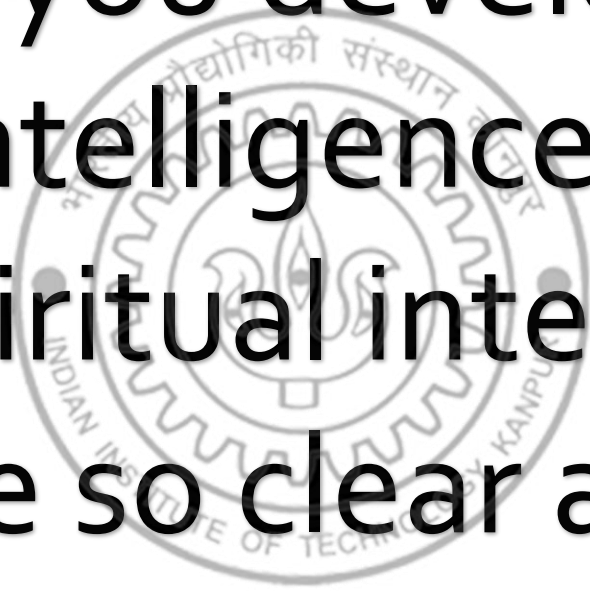
- **Perceptiveness**

Do you pay attention to the unspoken acts of communication? Do you feel that often people say something but they don't mean it, or mean exactly the opposite? Is your mind open while listening to controversial ideas? Do you understand people correctly?

- **Spiritual Intelligence**

Do you raise your life to a higher spiritual level? Do people look up to as their role models? Do you have the instinct in you to change the world and make it a better place? Do you transcend the mundane pettiness and live your noble self that is creative, loving, selfless, calm, compassionate, courageous and exemplary?

When you develop your
emotional intelligence and live with
high spiritual intelligence,
your life will be so clear and transparent
that even if anyone speaks badly of you
no one would believe it!



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Week 1
Module 5
Lecture 5

Highlights

Highlights of the Last Lecture



- Implicit Soft Skills taught:
- Self-Management
- Emotion Regulation
- Time-Management Skills



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- Self-Management Skills Set
- 1. Self-Awareness
- 2. Self-Confidence
- 3. Mind-Set
- 4. Emotional Balance
- 5. Stress Handling
- 6. Coping with Failure
- 7. Patience, Tolerance & Trustworthiness
- 8. Perceptiveness
- 9. Spiritual Intelligence

Towards Excellence

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- Excellence is an outstanding feature; possessing good qualities in high degree.
- Some are gifted with many talents and excel in many fields.
- Are you confident that you are excellent in any one aspect of your life or career?
- How do you rate yourself?
How do people rate you?
Poor, Average, Above Average, Good, Very Good, Outstanding/Excellent?
- If you want to excel in something, what do you need? Do you have it in you?
- Identify 5 traits in you that will certainly take you to excellence such as: Focused, strong will-power, highly determined, very optimistic, dedicated, punctual, etc.
- Are there other traits pulling you down from achieving excellence?
- Laziness, postponement, addictions (drug, TV, internet), low self-esteem, self-doubts, negative thinking, etc.

Stronger

Weaker

Law of Abundance

Courage

Risk

Confidence

Faith/Trust

Poverty of Mind

Fear

Restrictive

Low Self-Esteem

Suspicion/Doubt

**Inner
Core**

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Optimism

Growth mind-set

Learns from failure

Expects the best

Pessimism

Fixed Mind-Set

Depressed from failure

Expects the worst



Processing Excellence

- Knowing your Potential
- Creating a Vision

Kaikaku
(radical change)

- Identify your Mission
- Achieving your Vision

Kaizen
Continuous improvement

- Moving Forward
- Enhanced Vision
- Need-Achievement

Self-Actualisation

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Growth
Needs

Maslow's Hierarchy of Motivations



Emotional
Needs

Basic Needs





Self-Actualisation

Highest level of need for personal growth & self-fulfilment

Realization and fulfilment of one's talents and potentialities

To actualise what one is potentially

Expression of one's creativity

Efficient perceptions of reality.

Comfortable acceptance of self and others

Self-reliant and independent

Uses own experiences for judgment

Natural and spontaneous

Continued freshness of appreciation

Maintain deep loving bonds

Comfortable with solitude

They can laugh at themselves

Humble

Have peak experiences

Spiritual enlightenment

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**“A musician must make music,
an artist must paint,
a poet must write,
if he is to be ultimately at peace with
himself. What a man can be, he must be”**

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- Abraham H. Maslow

Less than 1% of adults achieve
total self-actualization



"self-actualisation... rarely happens... certainly in less than 1% of the adult population."

The fact that "most of us function most of the time on a level lower than that of self-actualization" is "the psychopathology of normality."

(Towards a Psychology of Being)

**If you plan on being anything
less than you are capable of being,
you will probably be unhappy
all the days of your life.**

(Abraham Maslow)



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Week 1
Module 6
Lecture 6

Need Achievement

Spiritual Intelligence

Highlights

Highlights of the Last Lecture



- Towards Excellence:
- Outstanding feature, possessing good qualities of high degree
- Rating by self and others
- Identifying potentiality for excellence
- Pursuing excellence by strengthening the inner core
- Law of abundance vs. poverty of mind
- Choices made out of fear followed by regret vs. the ones made out of courage and ends in fulfilment.
- Processing Excellence:
- Making radical changes and making constant improvement
- Moving from one vision/mission to other enhanced vision/mission
- Self-actualisation: highest level of growth need
- Actualising of one's potential, uniqueness and seeking self-fulfilment
- Although few people achieve self-actualisation fully, it is important to aspire for it as the unrealised and actualised people remain unhappy throughout their lives!

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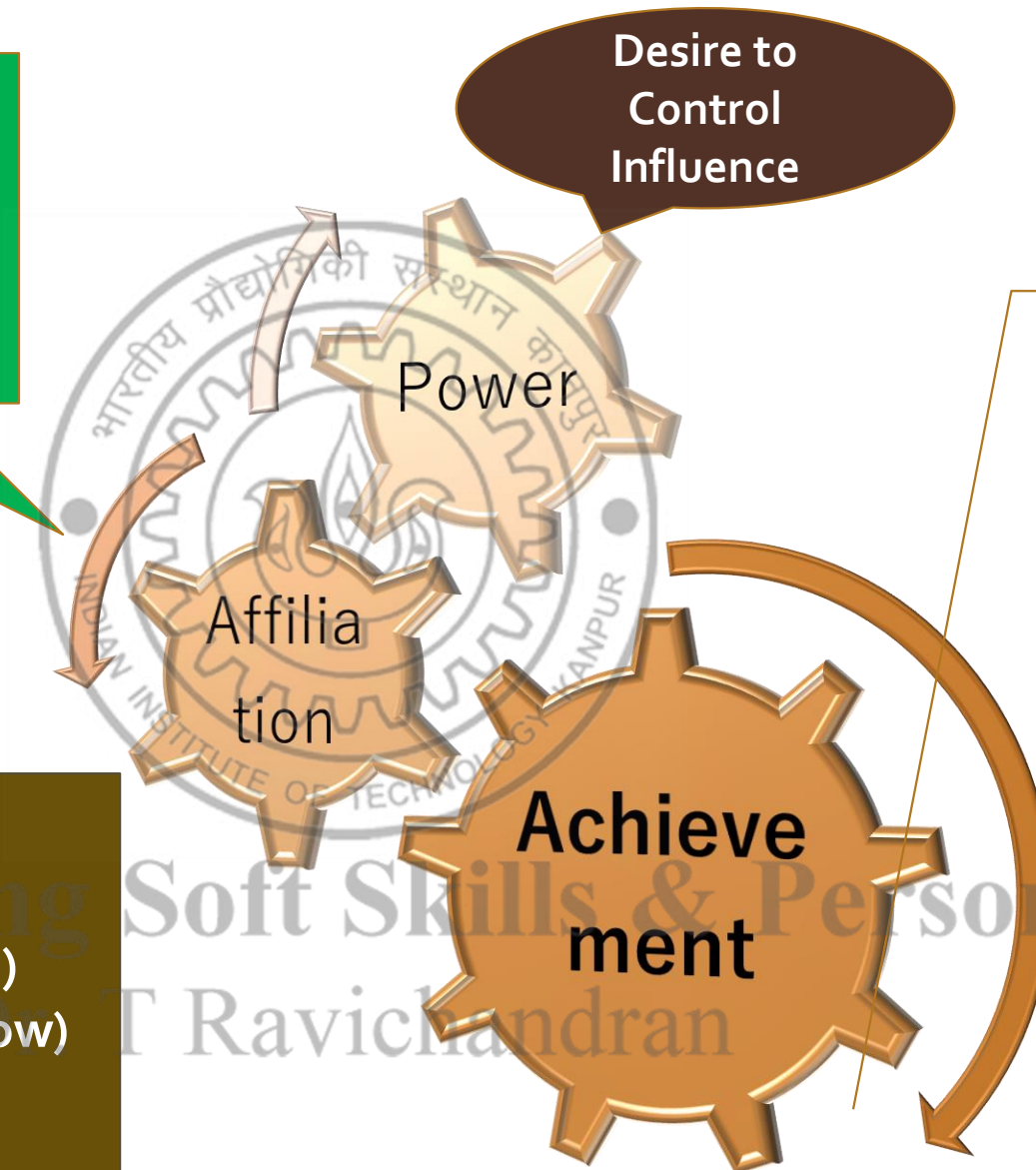
David McClelland, *The Achieving Society*

Desire to establish & maintain good relations with other people

Desire to Control Influence

Three Needs

achievement motivation (n-ach)
authority/power motivation (n-pow)
affiliation motivation (n-affil)

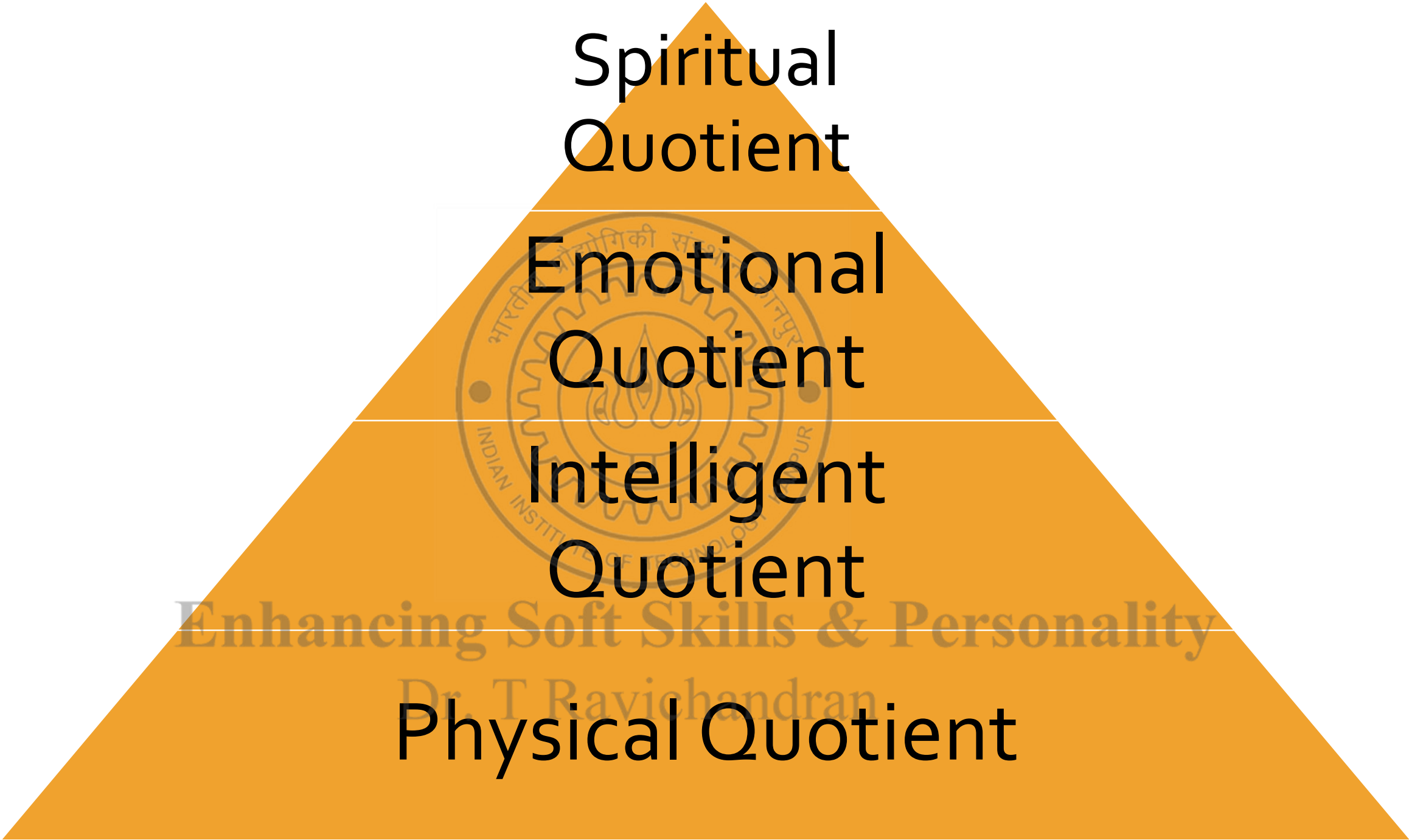


The desire to do something better, to solve problems, or to master complex tasks.

A desire to do well for the sake of an inner feeling of personal accomplishment.
A desire to excel. To achieve a goal in relation to a set of standards.

Strong need to set and accomplish challenging goals
Willing to take calculated risks
Optimistic and seeks feedback for constant improvement
Always finds ways for doing things better
Can work alone
Achievement is more important than material reward
Achievement gives greater personal satisfaction
Maintains high standards
Persists for longer
Takes responsibility for own actions
Intrinsically motivated





Spiritual
Quotient

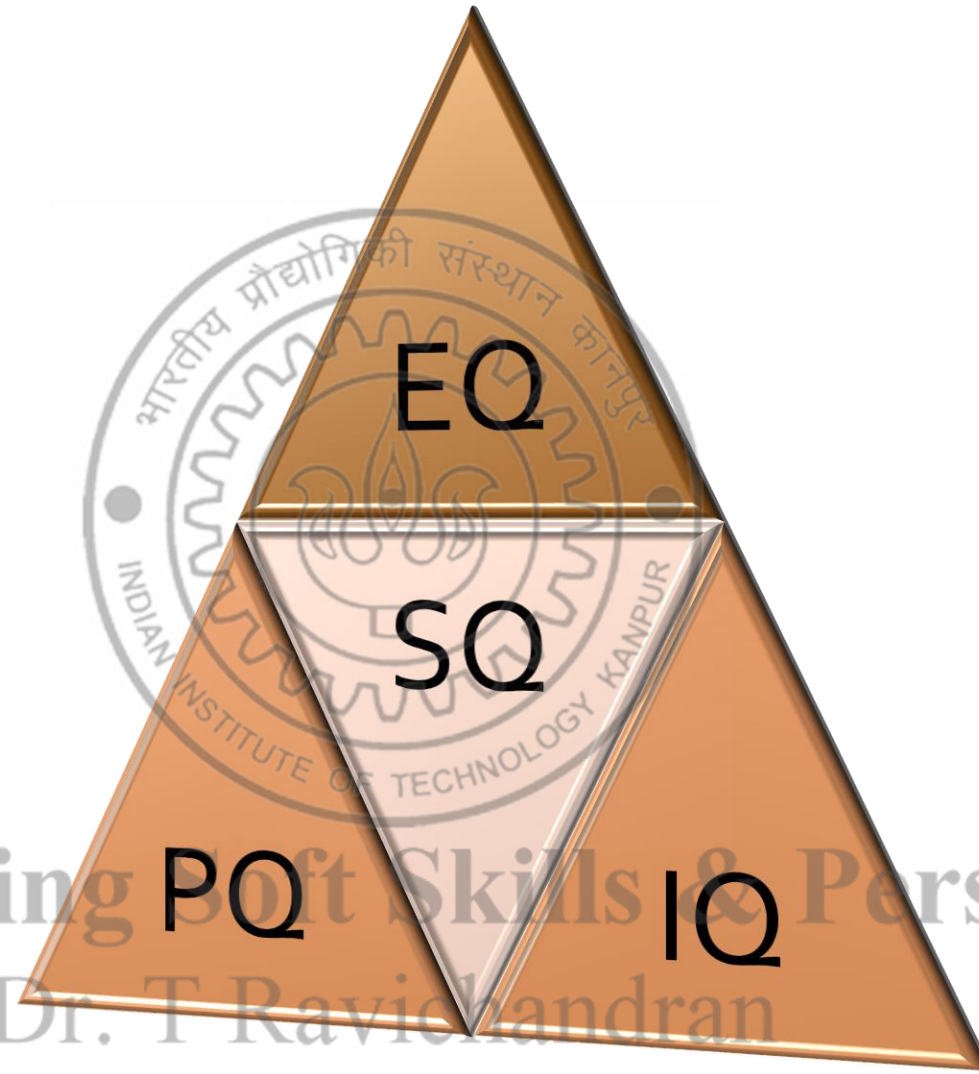
Emotional
Quotient

Intelligent
Quotient

Physical Quotient

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Danah Zohar *SQ: Connecting with Our Spiritual Intelligence*, London: Bloomsbury, 2000

Defined 12 principles underlying spiritual intelligence:

Self-awareness:

Knowing what I believe in and value, and what deeply motivates me.

Spontaneity:

Living in and being responsive to the moment.

Being vision- and value-led:

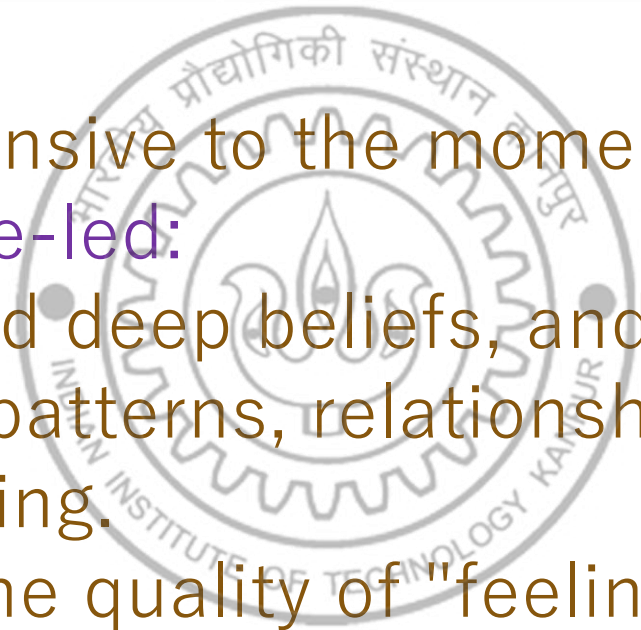
Acting from principles and deep beliefs, and living accordingly.

Holism: Seeing larger patterns, relationships, and connections; having a sense of belonging.

Compassion: Having the quality of "feeling-with" and deep empathy.

Celebration of diversity:

Valuing other people for their differences, not despite them.



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Danah Zohar *SQ: Connecting with Our Spiritual Intelligence*, London: Bloomsbury, 2000

Defined 12 principles underlying spiritual intelligence:

Field independence:

Standing against the crowd and having one's own convictions.

Humility:

Having the sense of being a player in a larger drama, of one's true place in the world.

Tendency to ask fundamental "Why?" questions:

Needing to understand things and get to the bottom of them.

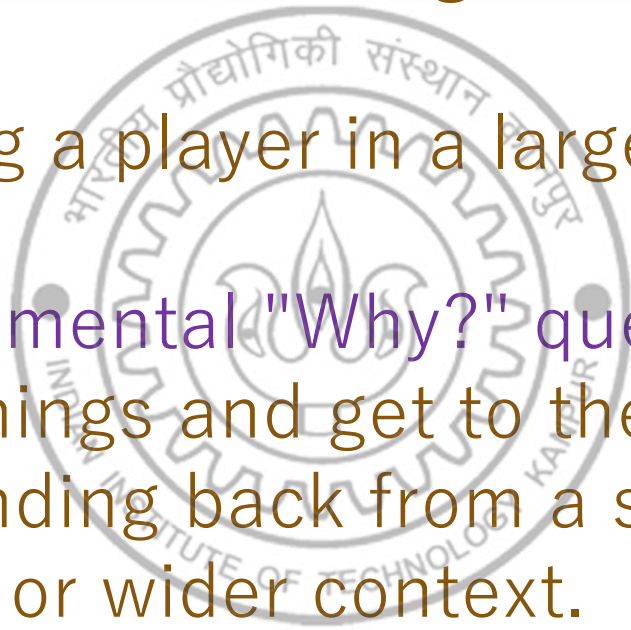
Ability to reframe: Standing back from a situation or problem and seeing the bigger picture or wider context.

Positive use of adversity:

Learning and growing from mistakes, setbacks, and suffering.

Sense of vocation:

Feeling called upon to serve, to give something back.



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**Dr^a
Dana
Zohar**

I now see spiritual intelligence as emerging from our most basic and primary need for and experience of deep meaning, essential purpose, and our most significant values and how these lead to a deeper, wiser, more questioning life and affect our decisions and experience.

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To become better, deeper, more spiritually intelligent people, we have to grow a dimension of our being that is sensitive to the deepest meanings of human life—a sensitivity, if you like, to Plato’s famous triad of values: Goodness, Truth, and Beauty.

We must live our lives as a vocation, as a calling to the service of those deepest values. To do that, we must act from the higher motivations that can drive human behavior. This is a long-term project, requiring tenacity and commitment.

Enhancing Soft Skills & Personality - **Danah Zohar** *Spiritual Capital*

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